

Library Enhancement Grant Scheme — Scheme Guidelines

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Issued in 2022 by Higher Education Department under reference HEIRS/SCH/2022/014, this scheme guidelines establishes the arrangements supporting Library Enhancement Grant Scheme. In scope are Library, Digital Collections, Grants, together with related expectations for institutions and stakeholders.

Background and Scope

The scheme landscape has evolved considerably in recent years, and institutions under Higher Education Department have responded with renewed attention to Library, Digital Collections, Grants. This scheme guidelines provides the framework needed to guide consistent practice across the sector.

Following sustained engagement with universities, colleges and sector bodies, Higher Education Department has prepared this scheme guidelines to give effect to Library, Digital Collections. It builds on earlier guidance while updating expectations to reflect current conditions.

Purpose and Intent

By setting out the rationale, scope and operating expectations for Library, the document aims to reduce ambiguity, support institutional planning and improve the quality of Digital Collections across the system.

The purpose of this document is to establish a consistent basis for Library, Digital Collections across Higher Education Department-affiliated institutions, to clarify responsibilities, and to define the outcomes expected of every stakeholder.

Policy Objectives

This document seeks to enhance institutional capacity for Library, Digital Collections, promote transparency in decision-making, and ensure that resources committed to related initiatives are used effectively.

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Scope

The provisions apply to all universities and colleges under Higher Education Department. Sector partners, including employers and professional bodies, are expected to support implementation within their respective spheres.

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Core Provisions

Key provisions establish minimum standards for Library, define the responsibilities of institutional leadership, and require documented arrangements for Digital Collections.

Institutions are required to integrate Library, Digital Collections into annual planning cycles, designate accountable officers, and maintain records demonstrating compliance with the expectations set out here.

Implementation Pathway

A dedicated implementation pathway, covering readiness assessment, capacity building and progressive rollout, has been designed to allow institutions of varying size and maturity to comply.

Implementation will proceed through phased institutional adoption, supported by professional development, shared guidance and a common reporting calendar established by Higher Education Department.

Accountability Framework

Heads of institutions bear overall responsibility for embedding Library, supported by designated coordinators, academic bodies and administrative units within each institution.

Higher Education Department provides policy direction, capacity support and performance oversight, while institutions translate the framework into operational practice and maintain day-to-day accountability.

Performance Monitoring

Progress will be monitored through annual institutional returns, targeted reviews and outcome indicators maintained centrally by Higher Education Department. Findings will inform guidance and, where necessary, corrective measures.

Closing Note

Effective implementation of Library Enhancement Grant Scheme will depend on sustained institutional commitment and close coordination between Higher Education Department and the sector. Institutions are encouraged to embed the arrangements described here into their normal planning and review cycles.